

Efficient Coinductives through State-Machine Corecursors

Optimising the terminal F-coalgebra in Set
for computational behaviour in Lean4

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Polynomials (background)



- A head H ,
- child families c_h in $h : H$.
- Morally, a collection of constructors H , and data at each constructor c_h .
- For now we will not consider “recursive” (inductive) data structures, rather I will have this be a variable we take the fix point in.
- Examples:
 - ▶ natural numbers $\text{NatF}(X) := 1 + X$,
 - ▶ lists $\text{ListF}(A, X) := 1 + A * X$,
 - ▶ streams $\text{StreamF}(A, X) := A * X$.

$$(h : H) \times c_h \rightarrow \alpha \equiv \sum_{h:H} \alpha^{c_h}$$

See (nLab authors, 2026) and (Neel Krishnaswami, 2026)

Coinductives (background)



- Unbounded tree of data.
- Greatest cofixpoint of a polynomial.
- Morally, the process of putting the word “lazy” in front of a functor,
 - on lists it sends them to lazy lists.
- Have a corecursion principle rather than an recursion principle,
 - instead of `rec : (f a → a) → fix f → a`,
 - we have `corec : (a → f a) → a → cofix f`.
- On our examples and their correspondences,
 - `cofix NatF`, natural numbers union infinity,
 - `cofix ListF(A)`, lists of `A`s with arbitrary length union streams of `A`,
 - `cofix StreamF(A)`, infinite streams of `A`s.

See (Avigad et al., 2019)

Performance of coinductives (core)



- Previous work has demonstrated implementation of coinductives.
- Computational behaviour was not a concern.

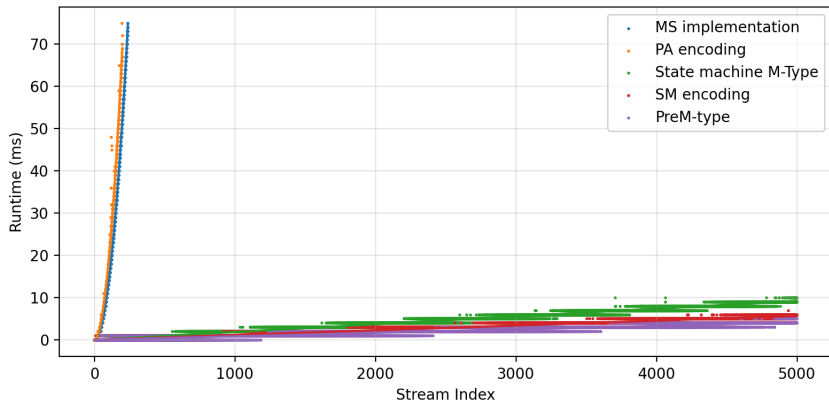


Figure 1: Performance of the old, new, and a perfect implementation

ABI Type (extension)



- Given $\alpha : \text{Type}_{\mathcal{U}}$, $\beta : \text{Type}_{\mathcal{V}}$ and $\text{eq} : \alpha \simeq \beta$.
- Univalence gives uniqueness.
- Adds a form of “weak-univalence”.
- Allows for a zero cost universe transliteration.
- Symmetric form of **Shrink**.

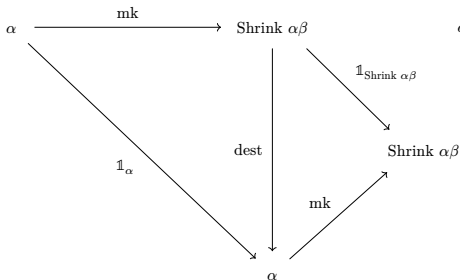


Figure 2: Operations on Shrink

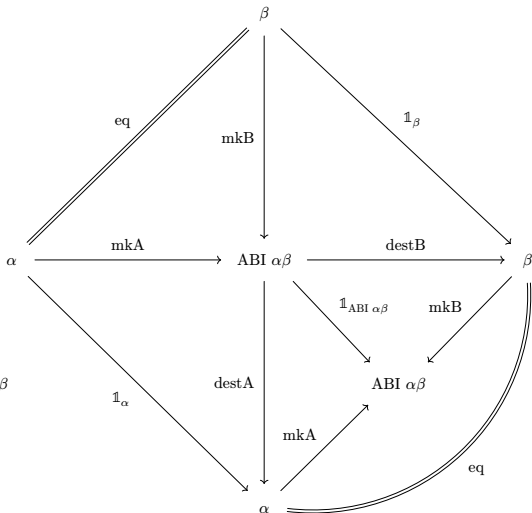


Figure 3: Operations on ABI

Interaction Trees (extension)



- Free monad with non-termination as an effect.

```
1 coinductive ITree
2   (E : Type u → Type u) (R : Type v) :=
3   | tau : ITree E R → ITree E R
4   | ret : R → ITree E R
5   | vis {A : Type u} (e : E A) (k : A → ITree E R)
```



Lean

- $\text{ITerm } E$ forms a monad,
 - With a method $\text{trigger} : EV \rightarrow \text{ITree } E V$,
 - and $\text{iter} : (A \rightarrow \text{ITree } E(A + B)) \rightarrow A \rightarrow \text{ITree } E B$.
- And an equivalence relation $A \approx B$,
 - satisfying $A \approx B \leftrightarrow \text{tau } A \approx B$.

Project statistics



```
> nix-shell -p cloc --run "cloc . --exclude-dir=.lake,ista-plv-  
coinductive,content,font"  
    97 text files.  
    86 unique files.  
    19 files ignored.
```

github.com/AlDanial/cloc v 2.06 T=0.06 s (1531.9 files/s, 229898.6 lines/s)

Language	files	blank	comment	code
Lean	64	1503	279	8768
Typst	6	211	96	658
Markdown	5	181	0	358
TeX	1	18	0	325
SVG	1	0	0	171
JSON	3	0	0	125
Python	2	23	19	70
YAML	3	8	7	69
Nix	1	2	0	15
SUM:	86	1946	401	10559

(excluding mathlib PRs)

Conclusion



- Lean now has usable coinductive datastructures,
 - core completed,
 - success criteria met.
- Lean now has an ITree implementation.
- Further work is being done on topics such as:
 - LLVM (VeIR) semantics,
 - productivity,
 - and CTrees.

Bibliography



- Avigad, J., Carneiro, M., & Hudon, S. (2019). Data Types as Quotients of Polynomial Functors. In J. Harrison, J. O’Leary, & A. Tolmach (Eds.), *10th International Conference on Interactive Theorem Proving (ITP 2019): Vol. 141. 10th International Conference on Interactive Theorem Proving (ITP 2019)*. <https://doi.org/10.4230/LIPIcs.ITP.2019.6>
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- Yang, Z., & Wu, N. (2022). Fantastic Morphisms and Where to Find Them. In E. Komendantskaya (Ed.), *Mathematics of Program Construction: Mathematics of Program Construction*.
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Further work

Futumorphic productivity (extension)



- A futumorphism is a morphism $(c \rightarrow f (\text{Free } f \ c)) \rightarrow c \rightarrow \text{cofix } f$,
- a terminating function in the futumorphism is exactly a productive one,
- futumorphisms have a unfold lemma which is very hard to prove.

See (Yang & Wu, 2022)

LLVM semantics (extension)



- Tobias Grosser's project VeIR wants formalised semantics,
- for this they want to use an ITree interpreter,
- semantics are detailed in (Zakowski et al., 2021).

CTree (extension)



- Another coinductive datastructure,
- has visible and silent non-determinism,

```
1 coinductive
2   (E B : Type u → Type u) (R : Type v) :=
3   | ret : R → ITree E R
4   | step : ITree E R → ITree E R
5   | guard : ITree E R → ITree E R
6   | vis {A : Type u} (e : E A) (k : A → ITree E R)
7   | br {A : Type u} (e : B A) (k : A → ITree E R)
8   | stuck
```



Lean

See (Chappe et al., 2023)